

AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements of the degree of

BACHELOR OF COMPUTER ENGINEERING

by

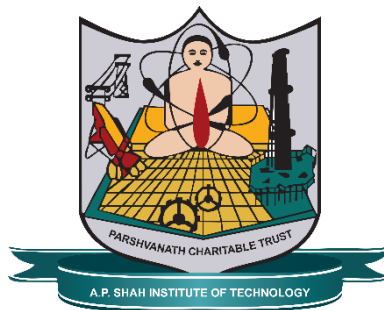
Krushnali Biradar, 22102039

Palak Boricha, 22102193

Gopika Barot, 22102189

Guide

Dr. Rushikesh R. Nikam



Department of Computer Engineering

A.P. SHAH INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, THANE

University of Mumbai

2025-2026



A.P. SHAH INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, THANE

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project entitled “**AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors**” is a bonafide work of **Krushnali Biradar (22102039), Palak Boricha (22102193), Gopika Barot (22102189)** submitted to the University of Mumbai in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the award of the degree of **Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering.**

Guide

Dr. Rushikesh R. Nikam

Project Coordinator

Dr. Rushikesh R. Nikam

Head of Department

Dr. Sachin H. Malave

Principal

Dr. Uttam D. Kolekar



A. P. SHAH INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, THANE

Project Report Approval for B.E.

This project report entitled “**AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors**” by **Krushnali Biradar, Palak Boricha, Gopika Barot** is approved for the degree of *Bachelor of Engineering* in *Computer Engineering*, 2025-26.

Examiner Name

Signature

1. _____

2. _____

Date:

Place:

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Krushnali Biradar - 22102039

Palak Boricha- 22102193

Gopika Barot- 22102189

Abstract

The rapid growth of the online art market is hampered by a significant challenge: the inability of buyers to accurately visualize artwork within their personal space. Traditional e-commerce platforms, relying on two-dimensional images, frequently lead to buyer hesitation, poor fit perception, and high return rates. This project addresses this limitation by developing a full-stack web platform for art collectors and artists with integrated Augmented Reality (AR) capabilities. The system features a dedicated artist portal for content management and selling, coupled with a buyer-facing e-commerce store. Crucially, buyers can utilize WebAR technology via their standard mobile devices to digitally place and view the artwork in their real-world environment, providing accurate scaling and spatial context before purchase.

The implementation of this immersive experience significantly reduces the visualization gap inherent in traditional online shopping, making the art acquisition process more interactive, personalized, and realistic. Ultimately, this system aims to increase buyer confidence, lower return rates, and boost conversion rates within the digital art market. The Platform fundamentally supports global sustainability goals. It advances SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities) by empowering artists worldwide with a direct-to-customer sales channel and ensuring equal market exposure.

Keywords: *Augmented Reality (AR) / WebAR, E-Commerce Platform, Art Collectors, In-Situ Visualization*

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ABBREVIATION

AR	Augmented Reality
XR	Extended Reality
MR	Mixed Reality
WebAR	Web-based Augmented Reality
AWS S3	Amazon Web Services Simple Storage Service
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete Operations
API	Application Programming Interface
AI	Artificial Intelligence
UML	Unified Modeling Language
DFD	Data Flow Diagram

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

The global art market has undergone a significant digital transformation, with an increasing volume of high-value transactions moving from physical galleries to online platforms. While this shift offers unprecedented accessibility for emerging and established artists, it simultaneously introduces a critical flaw in the consumer experience: the inherent inability of standard two-dimensional screens to convey the true scale, texture, and contextual fit of a physical piece of art. For art collectors, the decision to purchase is highly emotional and dependent on accurate spatial judgment—a judgment that is compromised when relying solely on static images and textual descriptions. This lack of in-situ visualization is the primary source of purchase hesitancy, high cognitive load for the buyer, and subsequent high rates of return, thereby suppressing the full potential of the digital art economy.

This project introduces a comprehensive, cutting-edge solution to this problem: an AR-enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors. By leveraging Augmented Reality (AR), specifically WebAR (Web-based Augmented Reality), the platform transcends the limitations of traditional e-commerce. This system is not merely a shopping site; it is an integrated ecosystem, featuring

a robust Artist Management Portal for inventory and sales control, and a secure E-Commerce functionality, ensuring a seamless, high-fidelity experience from creation to final purchase.

The AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors is fundamentally aligned with promoting sustainable and inclusive economic growth and innovation. The platform directly addresses SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities)

by serving as a professional, direct-to-customer digital channel. It empowers artists globally to generate sustainable income and bypass traditional, localized gallery systems, thereby providing equal exposure and selling opportunities regardless of the artist's geographical or socio-economic background. By democratizing access to the art market, the project ensures a wider, more diverse pool of artists can participate and thrive economically.

A key contribution of the project is to foster innovation and enhance critical infrastructure. The platform drives innovation by successfully merging cutting-edge Augmented Reality (AR) technology with the e-commerce framework. By relying on a sophisticated Microservices Architecture and tools like WebAR and Model-Viewer, the project demonstrates a robust, scalable digital solution that pushes the boundaries of online retail and art technology.

Furthermore, the project promotes sustainable cultural engagement, by offering the core AR feature, which allows buyers to visualize art in their homes in real-time, the platform makes cultural engagement more accessible than ever before. This eliminates the need for physical gallery visits, travel, and the potential transportation of returns, offering a convenient, modern solution for art selection. This shift towards a highly accurate digital preview supports a more sustainable consumption model by reducing logistical footprint and increasing purchase confidence, leading to fewer product returns.

CHAPTER 2

Literature Survey

The advancement of Augmented Reality (AR) and Extended Reality (XR) technologies has brought significant transformation in both e-commerce and digital art experiences. A. J. Ifeanyi demonstrates that AR in museum exhibitions enhances engagement and learning by overlaying digital information on physical artifacts, making the experience more interactive [1]. This concept directly supports the idea of integrating AR into online art platforms to simulate a real gallery-like experience. N. T. Singh et al. explore the integration of AR and VR in e-commerce and conclude that these technologies play a crucial role in bridging the gap between digital browsing and real-world product evaluation, thereby improving customer confidence and reducing hesitation during online purchases [2]. Similarly, H. Chen studies consumer psychology and finds that XR technologies significantly increase user trust, satisfaction, and reduce perceived risks, which is especially important in high-value purchases such as art [3].

Kumar and R. Verma identify AR as a major technological innovation that enhances product visualization and interaction, enabling users to better understand products before purchasing [4]. Supporting this, A. Gupta and R. Singh provide empirical evidence that AR not only

increases purchase intention but also enhances the consumer's willingness to pay higher prices, highlighting its strong commercial potential in e-commerce platforms [5].

In the domain of art and cultural representation, L. Wang and H. Zhou demonstrate that AR transforms traditional artworks into interactive and accessible digital exhibits, improving user understanding and engagement [6]. Patel and Rao further extend this idea through a VR-based shopping method that emphasizes contextual visualization of products, reinforcing the importance of immersive technologies in improving online retail experiences [7].

J. Li and M. Zhang shows that AR significantly improves user experience and purchase intention compared to traditional shopping [8], while Young and Marshall highlight its role in enhancing interaction and perception in public art [9]. Sharma and Kapoor identify AR as a transformative tool for immersive e-commerce [10], and Mehta and Choudhary discuss its opportunities and challenges, emphasizing performance and usability [11]. Rees describes AR as an “expansive object” that deepens emotional and contextual understanding of art [12], while Lupascu et al. focus on collaborative AR for improved interaction [13].

Suroto et al. highlight the role of digital technologies in enhancing museum experiences [14], Finally, Aitamurto et al. provide experimental evidence that AR improves user engagement, learning outcomes, and interaction quality, while maintaining a focused and immersive experience [15].

Overall, literature shows AR and XR enhance visualization, engagement, purchase confidence, and reduce uncertainty, supporting AR-enabled e-commerce especially in art, where visualization and emotional connection drive decisions.

2.1 Literature Survey Table

SR. NO	PAPER TITLE	KEY FINDINGS
1	“The Role of Augmented Reality in museum exhibitions: enhancing visitor engagement and learning” (2024)	The study emphasized how AR enriches visitor engagement and learning by allowing interactive exploration of artworks and historical artifacts. It showed that AR exhibits increase user curiosity and understanding through 3D visualization and contextual overlays. These insights influenced the development of immersive art previews in the proposed platform [1].
2	“Transforming E-Commerce: Augmented Reality (AR) and Virtual Reality (VR) Integration for Interactive and Immersive Shopping Experiences” (2024)	The paper explored integrating AR/VR into e-commerce platforms to create immersive shopping experiences. It found that such technologies enhance realism, reduce purchase hesitation, and improve customer satisfaction. These findings informed the AR-based visualization and user-interaction flow in the art gallery project [2].
3	“How Extended Reality Influences E-Commerce Consumers” (2024)	Highlighted the impact of Extended Reality (XR) combining AR, VR, and MR on user trust, engagement, and emotional connection during online shopping. The study demonstrated that immersive visualization strengthens customer confidence, forming the theoretical basis for using AR to improve buyer decision-making [3].

SR. NO	PAPER TITLE	KEY FINDINGS
4	“Digital Innovations in E-Commerce: Augmented Reality” (2024)	The authors discussed how AR serves as a digital innovation tool that transforms static online shopping into an interactive experience. It stressed that AR-driven visualization increases retention, engagement, and competitive advantage for businesses, motivating its adoption in digital art sales [4].
5	“The Impact of Augmented Reality on Consumers' Willingness to Pay in Mobile E-Commerce” (2023)	This study found that AR visualization in mobile commerce directly influences perceived product value and willingness to pay. Users who viewed products in AR were more confident and emotionally connected. The results support integrating AR to enhance buyer confidence in online art purchasing [5].
6	“Augmented Reality (AR) as a Tool for Engaging Museum Experience: A Case Study on Chinese Art Pieces” (2023)	Demonstrated that AR can bring cultural artifacts to life through interactive visual layers. The case study revealed that AR enhances user immersion and aesthetic appreciation. These findings were used to design the interactive visualization of artworks [6].
7	“PaRUS: A Virtual Reality Shopping Method Focusing on Context Between Products and Real Usage Scenes” (2023)	Provided the concept of contextual visualization showing artworks in real spaces via AR for realistic previews [7].

SR. NO	PAPER TITLE	KEY FINDINGS
8	“Augmented Reality Versus Web-Based Shopping: How Does AR Improve User Experience and Online Purchase Intention” (2023)	Used to justify the improvement of user experience and purchase intent through AR-based previews [8].
9	“An Investigation of the Use of Augmented Reality in Public Art” (2023)	Contributed to understanding how AR enhances interaction and accessibility for digital and public art displays [9].
10	“Augmented Reality in E-Commerce” (2022)	Provided a comprehensive overview of AR’s role in modern commerce, emphasizing how immersive visualization leads to higher consumer satisfaction. It outlined implementation strategies that were referenced while structuring the platform’s AR-based product display module [10].
11	“Augmented Reality in E-Commerce: A Review of Current Applications, Opportunities and Challenges” (2022)	Offered a detailed review of AR’s technical and commercial aspects, identifying major challenges like rendering accuracy and device compatibility. The findings guided system optimization and user accessibility planning in the proposed application[11].

SR. NO	PAPER TITLE	KEY FINDINGS
12	“Augmented Reality, the Expansive Object, and the Vivification of the Memory Theatre: Field Notes” (2022)	Focused on AR’s influence on perception and creativity, showing how augmented visualization alters memory and engagement with art. This theoretical foundation supported the development of meaningful and aesthetic AR interactions in the art gallery [12].
13	“ARThings Enhancing the Visitors’ Experience in Museums Through Collaborative AR” (2021)	Presented collaborative AR experiences that allow multiple users to engage with digital art simultaneously, inspiring social and interactive features [13].
14	“The Application of Technology in Museums.” (2020)	Reviewed technological innovations used in cultural and museum contexts, demonstrating how digital tools like AR and VR enhance interactivity and engagement. The study reinforced the role of digital transformation in art display and preservation [14].
15	“The Impact of Augmented Reality on Art Engagement: Liking, Impression of Learning, and Distraction” (2018)	Analyzed that AR increases engagement and perceived learning when interacting with art but requires careful design to avoid user distraction and immersive experience [15].

CHAPTER 3

Limitation of Existing system

Reliance on Mobile Device Capabilities and WebAR Limitations: The core functionality relies on buyers using their mobile device camera and the browser's WebAR capabilities. Older devices, specific operating system limitations, or browsers with limited WebAR support may prevent users from experiencing the full augmented reality preview, leading to a fragmented user experience.

Technical Complexity of 2D to 3D Conversion: The system requires a backend process using Flask (Python) to convert the artist's uploaded 2D artwork image files into .glb 3D models with virtual depth. The quality, accuracy, and efficiency of this automated conversion process can be a significant limitation. Inaccurate scaling or depth representation can misrepresent the artwork in AR, reducing buyer confidence.

Context-Dependent AR Efficacy: Although one literature survey paper suggests that AR improves user experience and purchase intention, it also notes that the findings may vary for art products due to the context-dependent nature of the AR experience.

Potential for Distraction over Enhancement: One of the drawbacks identified in the literature survey is that AR may sometimes distract instead of enhancing focus or engagement when interacting with artworks. The immersive AR feature, while interactive, may

inadvertently shift the user's focus away from the artistic details or emotional connection to the piece itself.

Scalability and Storage of AR Assets: The system stores both the original artwork image files and the generated .glb 3D frame models in a cloud storage solution like Firebase Storage or AWS S3. As the number of artwork listings grows, the storage and retrieval costs for these larger 3D model files (AR Assets) could become a significant financial and architectural challenge.

Initial Lack of Full CRUD Operations and Payment Integration: The project's pending work includes implementing full CRUD operations for effective artwork management and integrating a secure and reliable Payment Portal. Until these are fully implemented, the system has limited functionality for artists to manage their listings completely and cannot process seamless, secure transactions.

Limited Research on High-Value Art E-commerce: While a paper shows AR increases willingness to pay, its study was limited to mobile e-commerce and had less emphasis on high-value art. The system operates in the context of art sales, which may involve higher-value transactions where buyer confidence requirements are more stringent than for general e-commerce.

Focus on WebAR over Dedicated Application: The AR Preview relies on WebAR. While highly accessible, WebAR typically offers a less robust and feature-rich augmented reality experience compared to a dedicated mobile application (e.g., using ARKit or ARCore), potentially limiting the visual fidelity and advanced interaction capabilities.

CHAPTER 4

Problem Statement, Objectives and Scope

4.1 Problem Statement

Online art buyers cannot accurately visualize how pieces will look in their physical space, resulting in buyer uncertainty and high rates of abandoned purchases. This lack of spatial context reduces conversion rates for artists. Moreover, artists need a direct, engaging digital platform that offers integrated e-commerce and immersive art presentation.

4.2 Objectives

Develop a full-stack web platform for artists to upload and sell their artwork:

The goal is to build a complete, independent digital marketplace that gives artists a direct channel to manage and sell their work to a global audience.

Enable buyers to preview artwork in their real-world space using AR:

The feature is designed to eliminate buying hesitation by allowing customers to use their mobile devices to accurately visualize the artwork's scale and fit within their actual space

Seamlessly integrate e-commerce with immersive AR experience:

The objective is to combine a secure payment and browsing system with the AR preview, ensuring a cohesive, convenient, and technologically advanced art shopping journey.

Make art shopping more interactive, realistic, and personalized:

By merging e-commerce with AR, the platform delivers a modern solution that provides a more lifelike and engaging art selection process tailored to the buyer's individual space.

4.3 Scope

End-to-End E-commerce and Listing Management:

The platform includes a robust Artist Portal where sellers can register, securely upload high-resolution artwork images, define pricing, and manage their complete listing inventory. Simultaneously, the platform provides full E-commerce Functionality for buyers, enabling them to browse, filter, and make confident purchases through a secure payment gateway, with all activities supported by secure User Authentication for role-based access.

Augmented Reality (AR) Visualization System:

Delivers the immersive buyer experience by implementing Augmented Reality Integration. Buyers can instantly use their mobile device camera and WebAR capabilities to achieve a Real-Time AR Preview of the artwork, allowing them to visualize its true scale and aesthetic fit within their physical environment, thereby eliminating purchase hesitation.

System Administration and Responsive Infrastructure:

Ensures the platform's stability and usability by guaranteeing a Fully Responsive Web Platform design that performs seamlessly across different devices. A dedicated Admin Dashboard is included for monitoring all activity, and the backend incorporates comprehensive Order & Delivery Management features for tracking shipping updates and confirming successful transaction fulfillment.

CHAPTER 5

Proposed System

The AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors is designed to revolutionize the online art buying experience by bridging the gap between digital browsing and real-world visualization. The core feature is Augmented Reality (AR) Integration, which instantly projects a true-to-scale preview of any artwork onto the buyer's real-world environment, thus eliminating visualization struggles and boosting purchase confidence.

5.1 Modules:

Buyer Showcase & E-commerce: This is the customer-facing module covering the Homepage and E-Commerce Functionality, allowing users to browse, filter, and securely purchase artwork.

Artist Portal: The dedicated module for sellers to register, upload images, set pricing, and fully manage their artwork listings through an authenticated dashboard.

Augmented Reality (AR) Integration: The core technical feature that uses WebAR on mobile devices to provide a Real-Time Preview of the artwork, displaying its true scale and fit in the buyer's environment.

Admin Dashboard: This centralized control panel enables platform administrators to maintain system integrity. The admin can monitor user activity, approve new artist registrations, track transaction history, manage content, and oversee the Order & Delivery Management process for successful fulfillment.

User Authentication & Authorization: This foundational module provides a secure login/signup system for both artists and buyers. It manages all user sessions and implements role-based access control, ensuring that only authorized users can access sensitive features like the Artist Portal or the Admin Dashboard.

5.2 Architecture Diagram:

In 5.2. Architectural diagram is a visual representation that maps out the physical implementation of the components of the software system. The AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors utilizes a Microservices Architecture centered around an API Gateway. The system is modular, consisting of distinct Client Side applications communicating with specialized Backend Services like the AR Service, Auth Service, and Catalog Service. Each service is linked to its own Database or Storage, ensuring scalability and data handling for all core functions, including Orders & Payment processing via an external Payment Gateway.

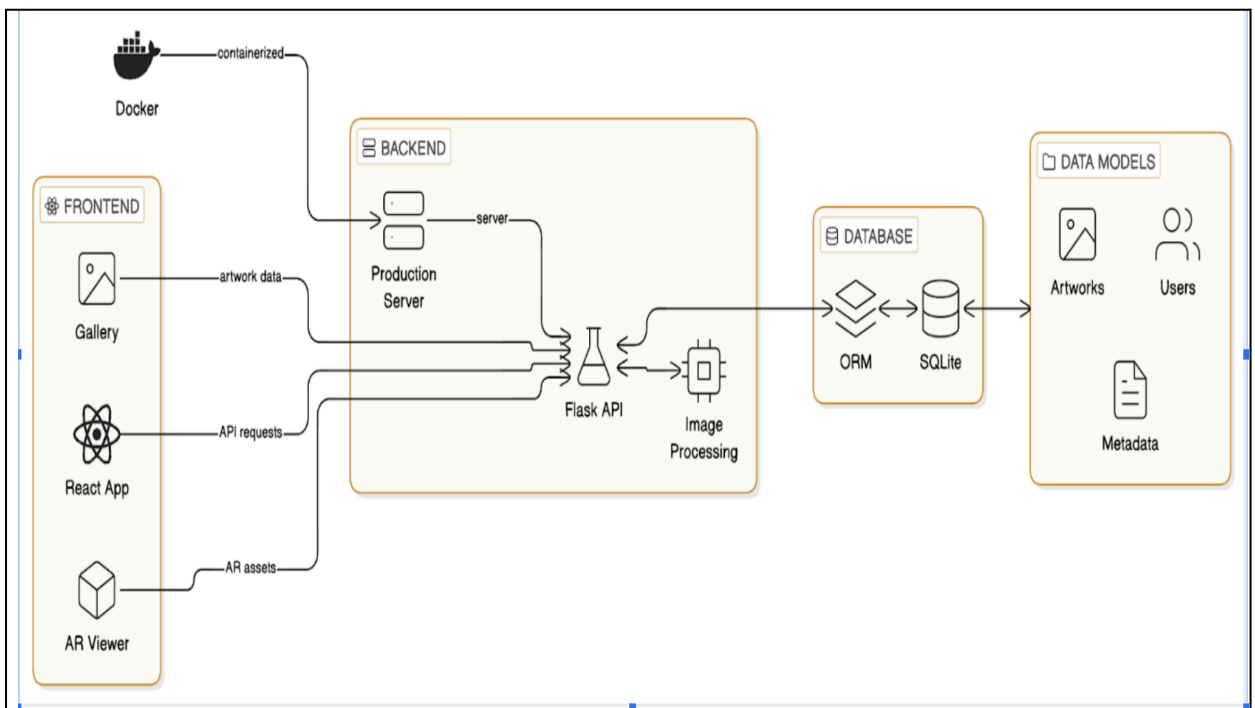


Figure 5.2 – Architecture Diagram

5.3 UML Diagrams:

The Figure 5.3 UML diagram is based on the UML (Unified Modelling Language) to visually represent a system along with its main actors, roles, actions, artifacts, or classes, to better understand, alter, maintain, or document information about the system.

5.3.1 DFD Diagram

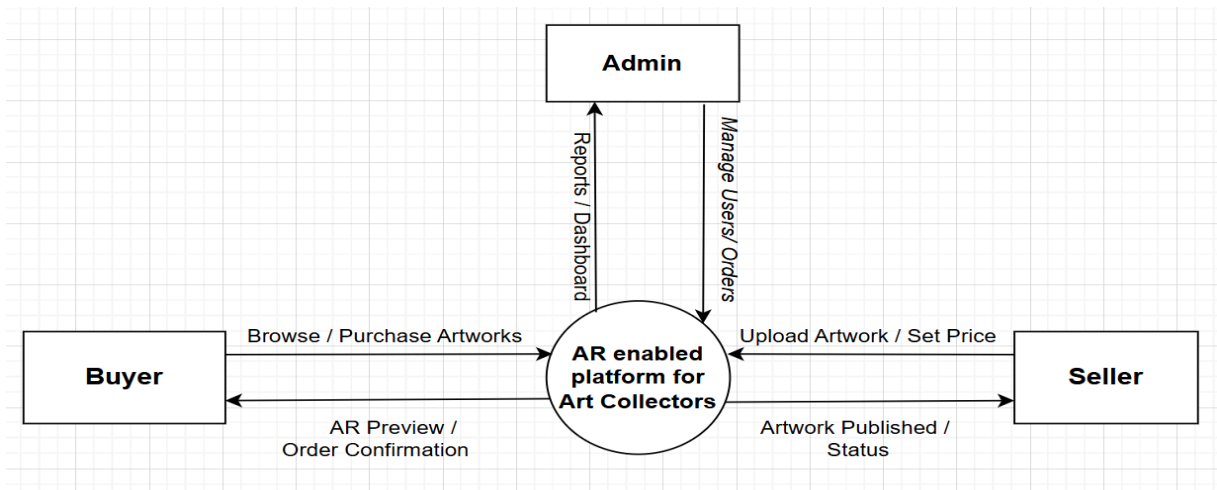


Figure 5.3.1 – DFD Level 0 Diagram

The above Figure 5.3.1 data flow diagram (DFD) maps out the flow of information for any process or system. It uses defined symbols like rectangles, circles, and arrows, plus short text labels, to show data inputs, outputs, storage points, and the routes between each destination. At Data Flow Diagram (DFD) level 0 for AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors, the diagram depicts the main external entities: User and Admin.

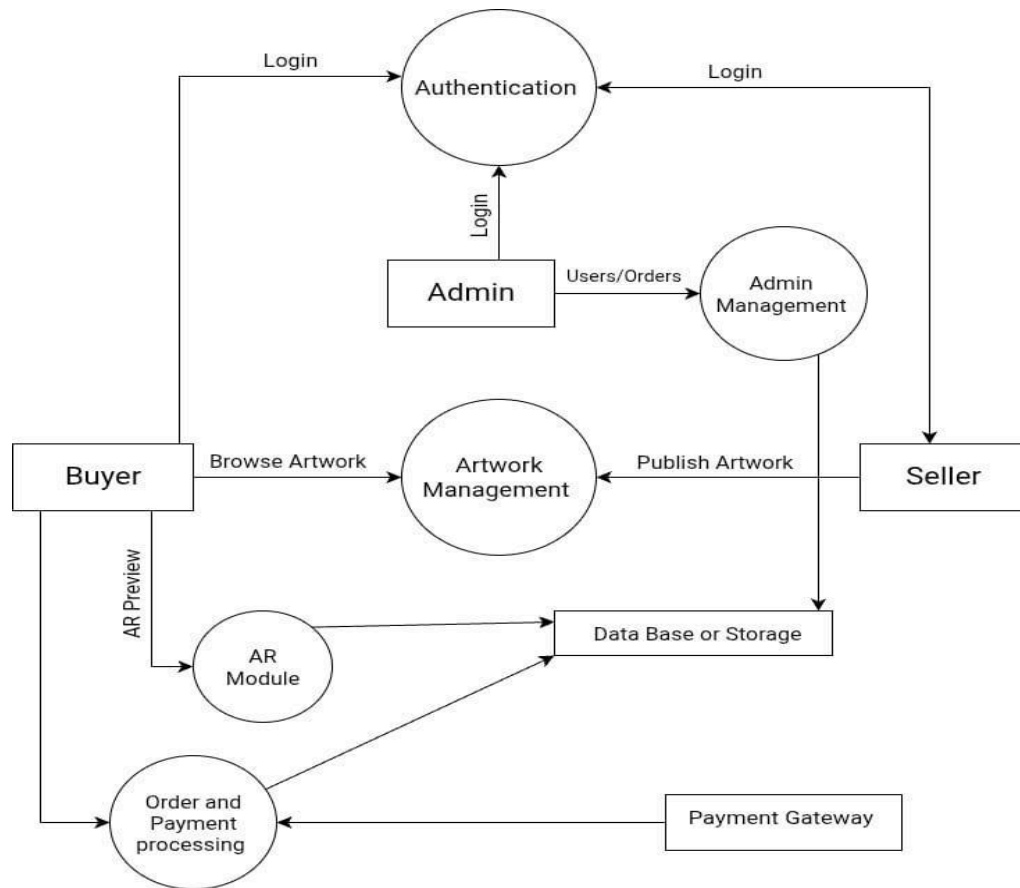


Figure 5.3.2 – DFD Level 1 Diagram

In above Figure 5.3.2 DFD Level 1 is for the AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors, the primary platform process is detailed into core functional subprocesses. These include Authentication for managing user login across all roles, Artwork Management for handling new listings and catalog display, the AR Module for generating and serving the real-time art preview, and Order and Payment Processing which interfaces with the Payment Gateway.

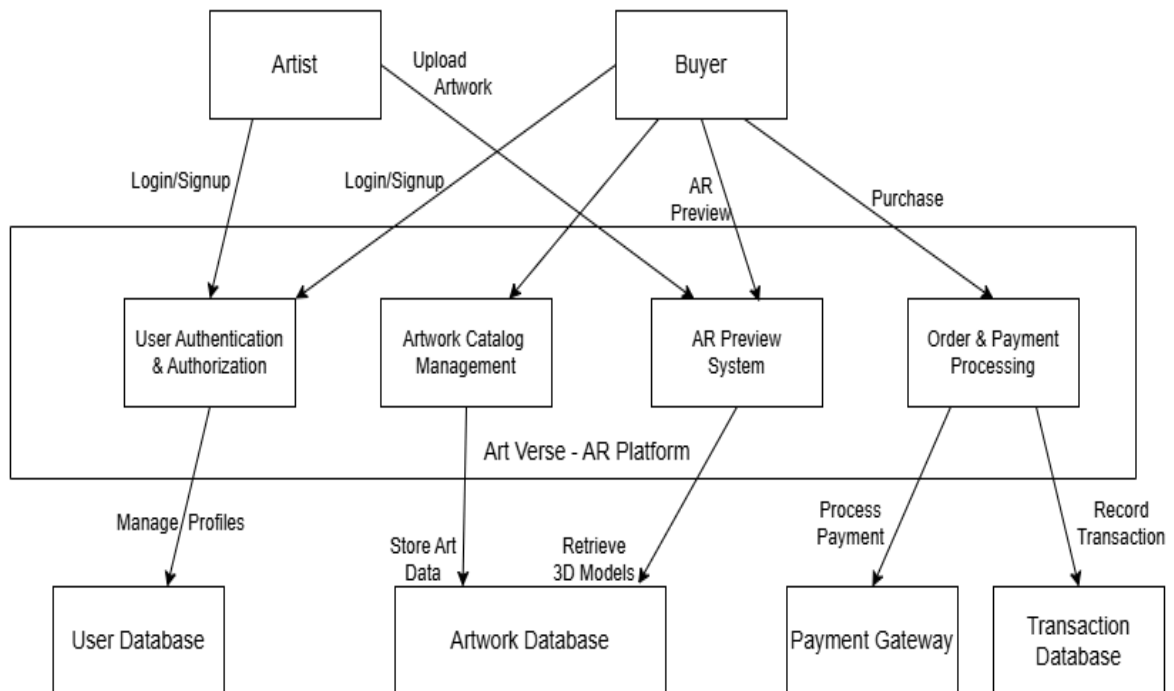


Figure 5.3.3 – DFD Level 2 Diagram

The Figure 5.3.3 DFD Level 2 is the diagram for the project breaks down the platform into four primary and interdependent systems: User Authentication & Authorization, which manages all login and account profiles for artists and buyers; Artwork Catalog Management, which handles storing and retrieving all art data; the AR Preview System, which processes and serves the 3D models required for visualization; and Order & Payment Processing, which coordinates all transaction records with the dedicated databases.

5.4 Sequence Diagram

In Figure 5.4 sequence diagram the AR enabled E-Commerce Platform illustrates the dynamic, chronological flow of communication and data between the actors (Collector and Artist) and the system components (E-commerce Platform, AR Module, Payment Gateway, and Database). This diagram visualizes two key use cases: the buyer's process of browsing, viewing art in AR, and purchasing, and the artist's action of uploading new artwork, showing how messages are passed and data is retrieved or stored in sequence

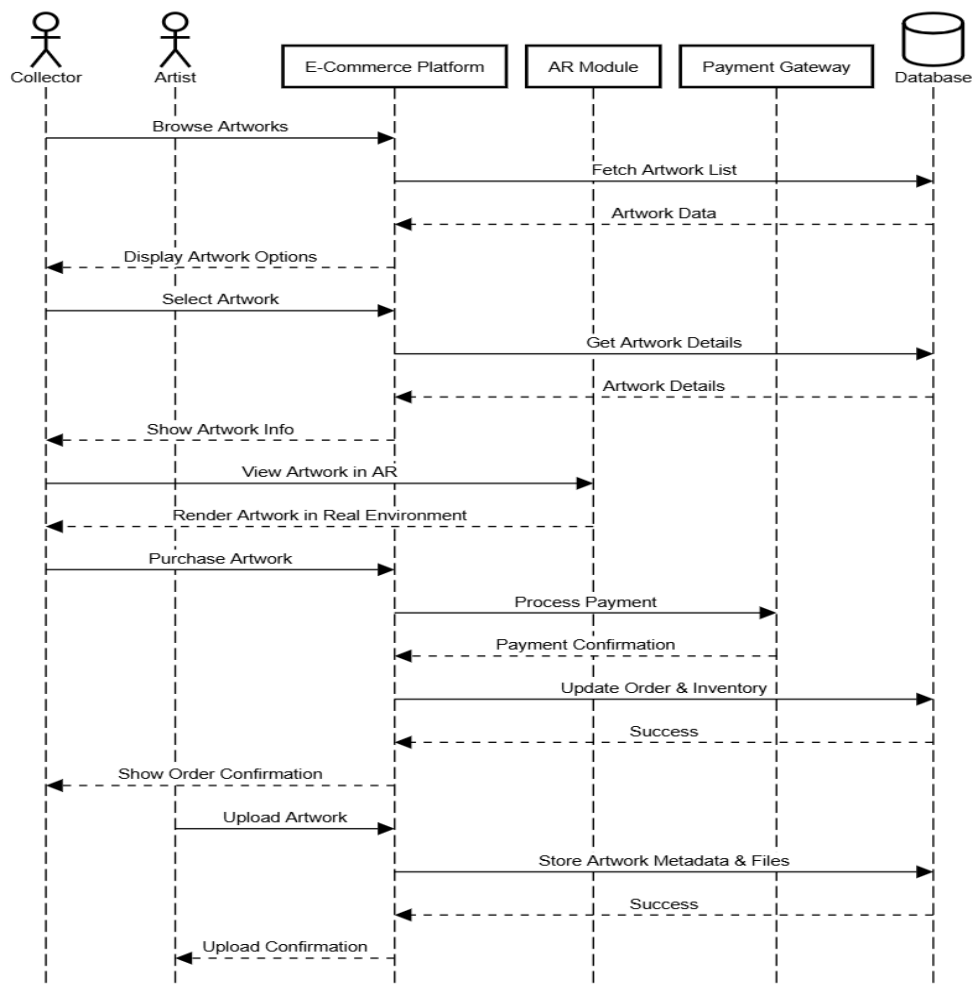


Figure 5.4 Sequence Diagram

5.5 Activity Diagram

The Figure 5.5 activity diagram for the AR enabled E-Commerce Platform illustrates the sequential flow of actions and decisions within the two primary user journeys: the Buyer's purchasing process and the Artist's upload process. This diagram clearly outlines the parallel activities that start with the common Login and branch to show the steps involved in browsing art, viewing in AR, and purchasing, versus the steps for uploading art and setting the price, before both paths conclude at the Logout step.

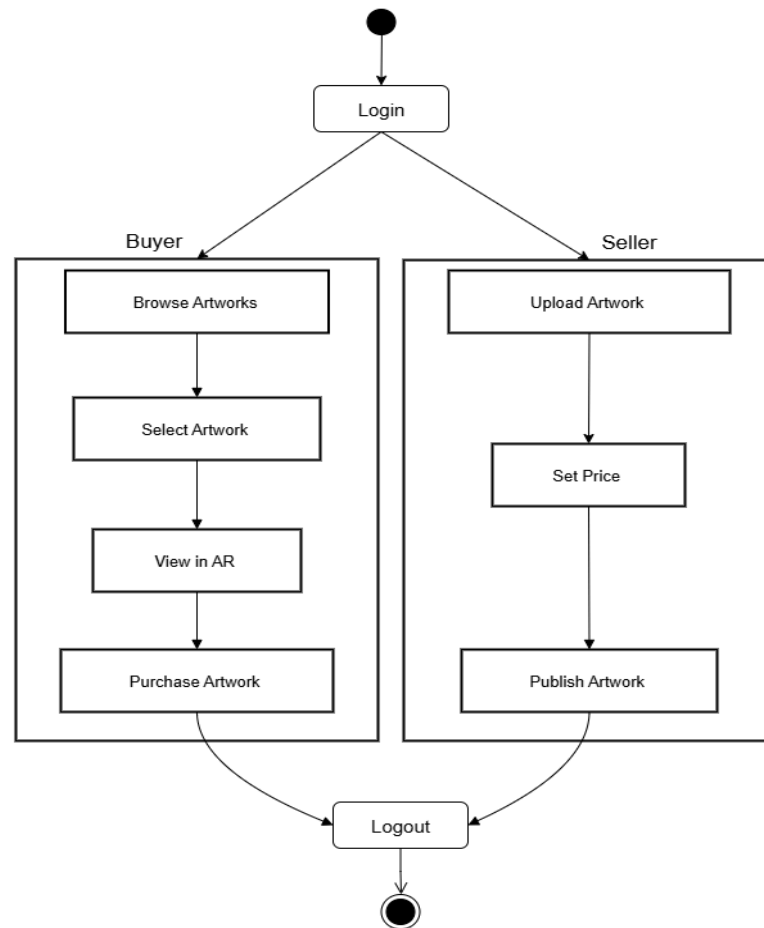


Figure 5.5 Activity Diagram

CHAPTER 6

Experimental Setup

6.1 Technology Stack

6.1.1 Frontend:

For developing the web application to implement our problem definition efficiently and user-friendly, we have used the following technologies:

6.1 System Architecture

6.1.1 Frontend

a. React

React 18 is used as the foundational library for building the entire user interface. It enables the creation of fast, dynamic, and reusable UI components for all parts of the application — from the Artist's secure upload forms to the Buyer's art gallery. React's component-based architecture, combined with React Router DOM v6 for client-side navigation, ensures the application is highly interactive and easy to maintain

Tailwind CSS (v4) is a utility-first framework used for rapid, precise styling. It provides low-level utility classes applied directly in the component markup, enabling a fully responsive design that adapts to every screen size — desktop, tablet, and mobile. Framer Motion is additionally used for fluid animations and transitions across the UI

b. Three.js / React Three Fiber

Three.js, accessed via the `@react-three/fiber` and `@react-three/drei` abstraction libraries, is used for 3D scene rendering within the browser. It powers the interactive 3D artwork previews in the gallery, rendering the .glb models generated by the backend directly in the browser without a plugin.

c. Google Model Viewer ()

The `@google/model-viewer` v1.12.0 web component is the key enabler of the platform's AR experience. It is embedded in the AR Viewer page and handles rendering the .glb 3D frame models directly in the browser. Critically, it uses the buyer's mobile device camera to trigger a WebAR view, allowing users to place the artwork into their real physical environment directly within the browser — no separate app required.

6.1.2 Backend

a. Flask

Flask, a lightweight Python micro-framework, serves as the sole backend of the platform. It handles all server-side responsibilities: user authentication, the artwork REST API, 3D model generation, and order/payment processing. There is no separate Node.js server — Flask manages the entire backend lifecycle, served in production via Gunicorn as the WSGI server.

b. trimesh + Pillow (Image-to-GLB Pipeline)

The 2D-to-3D conversion pipeline uses Pillow for image processing (loading, color/contrast enhancement) and trimesh to construct a textured box mesh with the artwork image applied as

a UV-mapped texture. This mesh is then exported as a binary .glb file, which is stored in the database and served to the buyer's device for AR preview.

c. spaCy (Recommendations)

spaCy (`en_core_web_sm` model) supports the artwork recommendation engine, which combines image histogram similarity, textual description overlap, and metadata matching (artist, style, medium) to suggest related artworks to buyers.

6.1.3 Storage, Database & Authentication

a. Database

SQLite is used as the relational database, managed through the SQLAlchemy ORM via Flask-SQLAlchemy. It stores all structured application data: user accounts, artwork metadata (title, price, artist, style, medium, dimensions), binary image and GLB assets, and order/transaction state (e.g., `is_sold` flag).

b. Authentication

Authentication is implemented as a custom session-based system built directly with Flask. Passwords are securely hashed using Werkzeug's `generate_password_hash` / `check_password_hash` (PBKDF2-SHA256). User sessions are managed via Flask's server-side session mechanism. There is no Firebase Auth dependency.

c. Payments

Razorpay is the integrated payment gateway (v2.0.0 Python SDK + Razorpay Checkout.js on the frontend). It handles order creation, payment processing, and HMAC-SHA256 signature verification for secure payment confirmation.

6.2 Software and Hardware Setup

Software Requirements:

- Python 3 + Flask 2.2.5
- React 18 + Vite 5
- Tailwind CSS v4
- trimesh 4.8.3 + Pillow 10.1.0 (GLB generation)
- SQLite + SQLAlchemy 2.0 / Flask-SQLAlchemy 3.0.5
- Werkzeug (password hashing & session auth)
- Gunicorn (production WSGI server)
- Google Model Viewer v1.12.0 (WebAR)
- Three.js / @react-three/fiber (3D rendering)
- Razorpay (payment gateway)
- spaCy 3.7.2 (artwork recommendations)
- Docker + Docker Compose (containerized deployment)

Hardware Requirements:

1. Mobile Device

CHAPTER 7

Implementation and Result

In this project, the below module enables Augmented Reality (AR) visualization of artworks using WebAR technology. The `<model-viewer>` component is used to load 3D GLB models generated by the backend. The `ar` attribute activates AR capabilities, while `ar-modes="webxr scene-viewer quick-look"` ensures compatibility across Android and iOS devices.

```
<model-viewer
  ref={viewerRef}
  src={glbUrl}
  ar
  ar-modes="webxr scene-viewer quick-look"
  ar-scale="auto"
  camera-controls
  auto-rotate>
</model-viewer
```

When the user clicks the AR button, camera access is requested using the browser's media API. After permission is granted, the `activateAR()` function launches the AR environment, allowing users to place and view artworks in their real-world surroundings. This module enhances user interaction by providing an immersive experience where digital artwork can be visualized in physical space.

```
const handleARClick = async () => {  
  const viewer = viewerRef.current;  
  if (!viewer) return;  
  try {  
    // Request camera permission  
    const stream = await navigator.mediaDevices.getUserMedia({ video:  
true });  
    stream.getTracks().forEach((t) => t.stop());  
    // Launch AR mode  
    viewer.activateAR();  
  } catch (err) {  
    console.error("AR launch failed:", err);  
  }  
};
```

The below code defines how it converts 2D artwork images into 3D GLB models for augmented reality visualization. The input image is processed and its aspect ratio is calculated to maintain correct proportions. A 3D box structure is created using the trimesh library, representing the artwork frame.

```
def create_glb_from_image(file_like, width_m=0.6, thickness_m=0.01):  
  img = Image.open(file_like).convert("RGB")  
  w_px, h_px = img.size
```

```

    aspect = h_px / float(w_px)

    W = float(width_m)

    H = W * aspect

    T = float(thickness_m)

    box = trimesh.creation.box(extents=(W, H, T))

    box.apply_translation((0, 0, T / 2.0))

    uv = np.zeros((len(box.vertices), 2), dtype=np.float32)

    verts = box.vertices

    min_xy = verts[:, :2].min(axis=0)

    max_xy = verts[:, :2].max(axis=0)

    span_xy = np.maximum(max_xy - min_xy, 1e-8)

    uv[:, :] = (verts[:, :2] - min_xy) / span_xy

    texture = trimesh.visual.texture.TextureVisuals(uv=uv, image=img)

    box.visual = texture

    glb_bytes = box.export(file_type="glb")

    return glb_bytes

```

The image is then applied as a texture onto the 3D surface using UV mapping techniques. This ensures that the artwork appears correctly on the model. Finally, the 3D object is exported as a .glb file, which is compatible with AR systems and can be rendered in real-world environments.

```

@auth_bp.route("/signup", methods=["POST"])

def signup():

    name = (request.form.get("name") or "").strip()

    email = (request.form.get("email") or "").strip().lower()

    password = request.form.get("password") or ""

    if User.query.filter_by(email=email).first():

```

```

        return Response("Account already exists", status=400)

    user = User(
        name=name,
        email=email,
        password_hash=generate_password_hash(password)
    )

    db.session.add(user)

    db.session.commit()

    session["user_id"] = user.id

    return redirect(url_for("spa.select_role"))

```

This handles user authentication, including user registration and login functionality. During signup, user details such as name, email, and password are collected and stored in the database. Passwords are securely hashed using built-in security functions before storage

```

@auth_bp.route("/login", methods=["POST"])
def login():

    email = (request.form.get("email") or "").strip().lower()

    password = request.form.get("password") or ""

    user = User.query.filter_by(email=email).first()

    if not user or not check_password_hash(user.password_hash,
password):

        return Response("Invalid email or password", status=401)

    session["user_id"] = user.id

    return redirect(url_for("spa.select_role"))

```

During login, the entered credentials are validated by comparing the hashed password with the stored value. Upon successful authentication, a user session is created using session management, allowing secure access to protected features of the application. This ensures that only authenticated users can interact with the system, maintaining data security and user privacy.

Now, let us explore the user interface design of the proposed system and understand how users can seamlessly navigate through the AR-enabled art e-commerce platform.

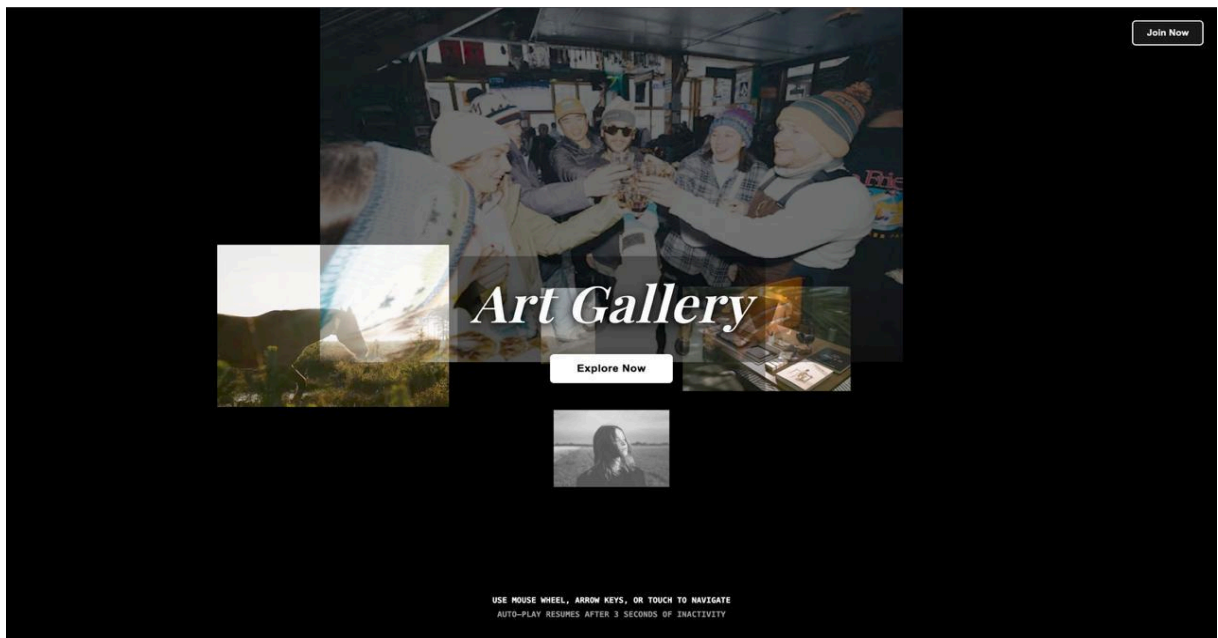


Figure 7.1 ArtVerse Platform Landing Interface

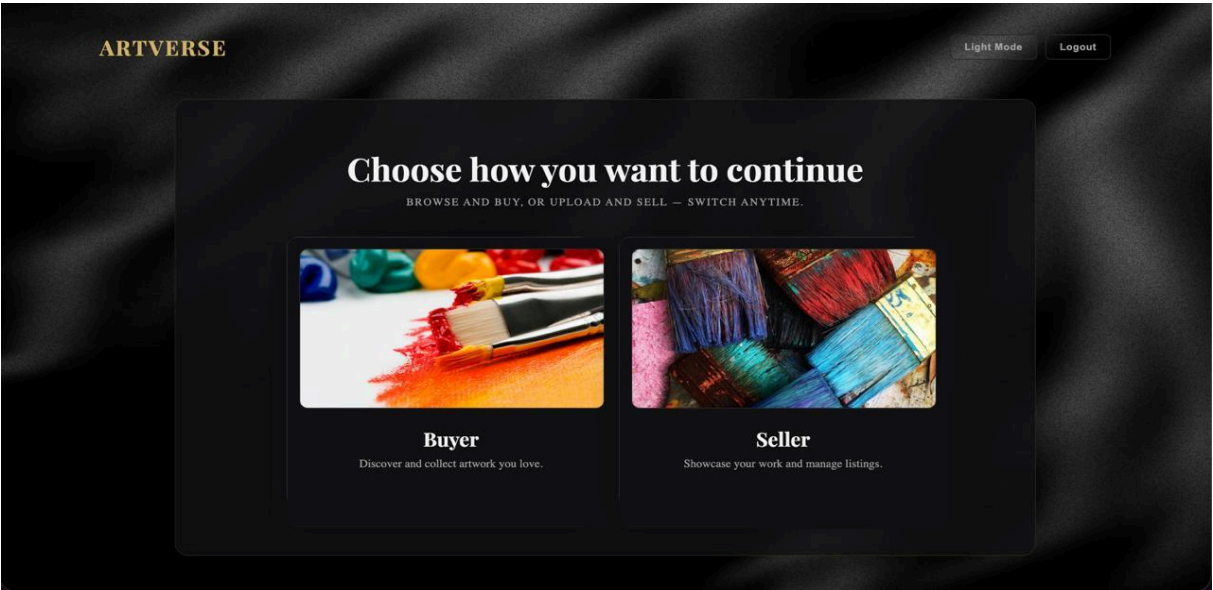


Figure 7.2 ArtVerse Platform Home Page

The Figure 7.2 depicts the Role-Based Access Control page, where the authenticated user selects their profile either Buyer or Seller to access the corresponding platform features.

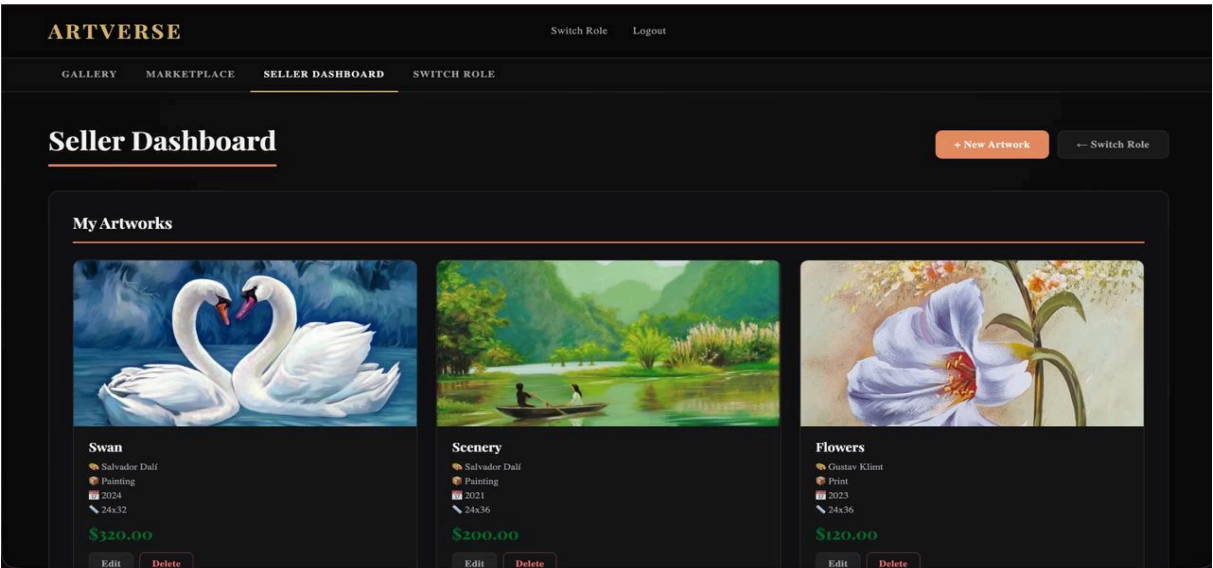


Figure 7.3 Seller Dashboard Interface

The Figure 7.3 shows the seller dashboard where artists can manage and upload artworks. It displays artwork details like title, artist, and price, with options to add and manage listings efficiently.

The screenshot shows the 'ARTVERSE' Seller Dashboard. At the top, there are navigation links: GALLERY, MARKETPLACE, SELLER DASHBOARD (active), and SWITCH ROLE. The main heading is 'Seller Dashboard'. Below it, there's a 'Cancel' button and a 'Switch Role' button. The central section is titled 'Upload New Artwork'. It contains a form with the following fields: 'ARTWORK IMAGE *' with a 'Choose file' button and 'No file chosen' text; 'ARTWORK NAME *' with a text input; 'ARTIST' with a text input; 'PRICE (\$)' with a text input showing '0.00'; 'TYPE' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select type'; 'YEAR CREATED' with a text input showing '2025'; 'MEDIUM' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select medium'; 'DIMENSIONS' with a text input showing 'e.g. 24x36 inches'; 'STYLE' with a dropdown menu showing 'Select style'; and a 'DESCRIPTION' text area with the placeholder 'Describe your artwork...'. At the bottom of the form are 'Create Artwork' and 'Cancel' buttons.

Figure 7.4 Artwork Upload Form

Figure 7.4 displays the form for sellers to upload new artworks to the platform. It includes fields for entering artwork details such as name, artist, price, dimensions, and description. This feature enables easy and structured addition of new listings to the marketplace.

The screenshot shows a grid of artworks on the seller's dashboard. Each artwork card displays the title, artist, medium, year, dimensions, price, and status. The 'Swan' artwork by Salvador Dali is a painting from 2024, 24x32 inches, priced at \$320.00. The 'Scenery' artwork by Salvador Dali is a painting from 2021, 24x36 inches, priced at \$200.00. The 'Flowers' artwork by Gustav Klimt is a print from 2023, 24x36 inches, priced at \$120.00. The 'FaceArt' artwork by Test12 is a painting from 2024, 22x22 inches, priced at \$100.00, and is marked as 'SOLD'. Each card has 'Edit' and 'Delete' buttons. A red 'SOLD' badge is visible on the 'FaceArt' card. A green checkmark and the text 'This artwork has been sold' are shown below the 'FaceArt' card.

Figure 7.5 Artwork Status and Management Interface

Figure 7.5 shows the seller’s artworks with their status, including sold items, and allows easy editing, deletion, and inventory tracking.

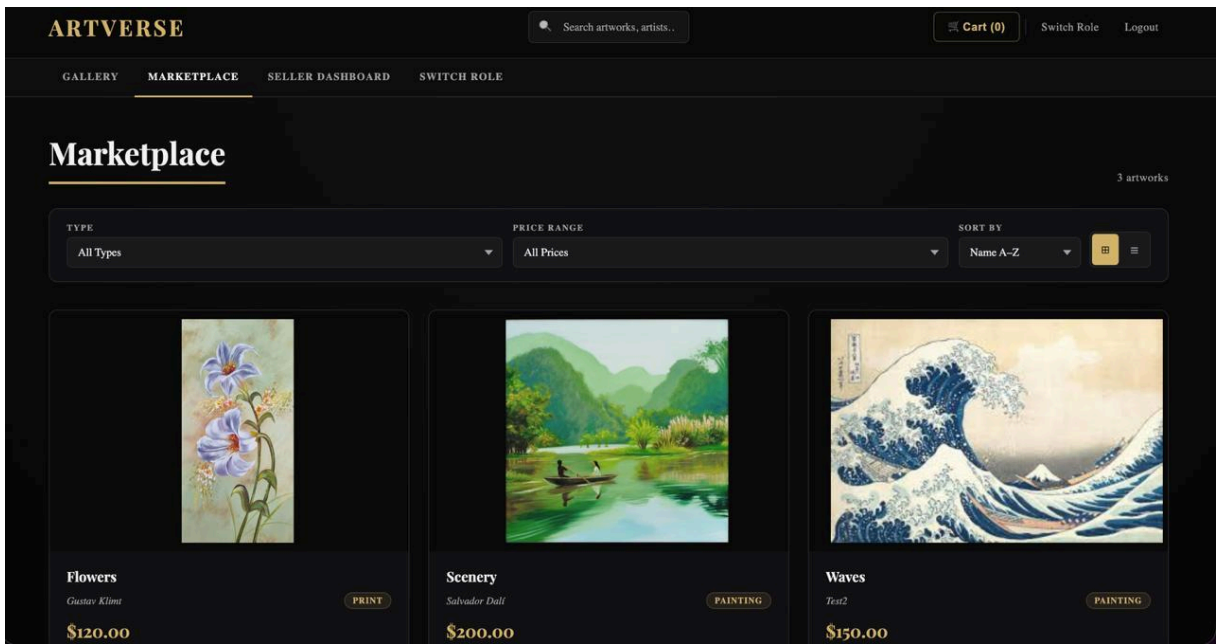


Figure 7.6 Marketplace Browsing Interface

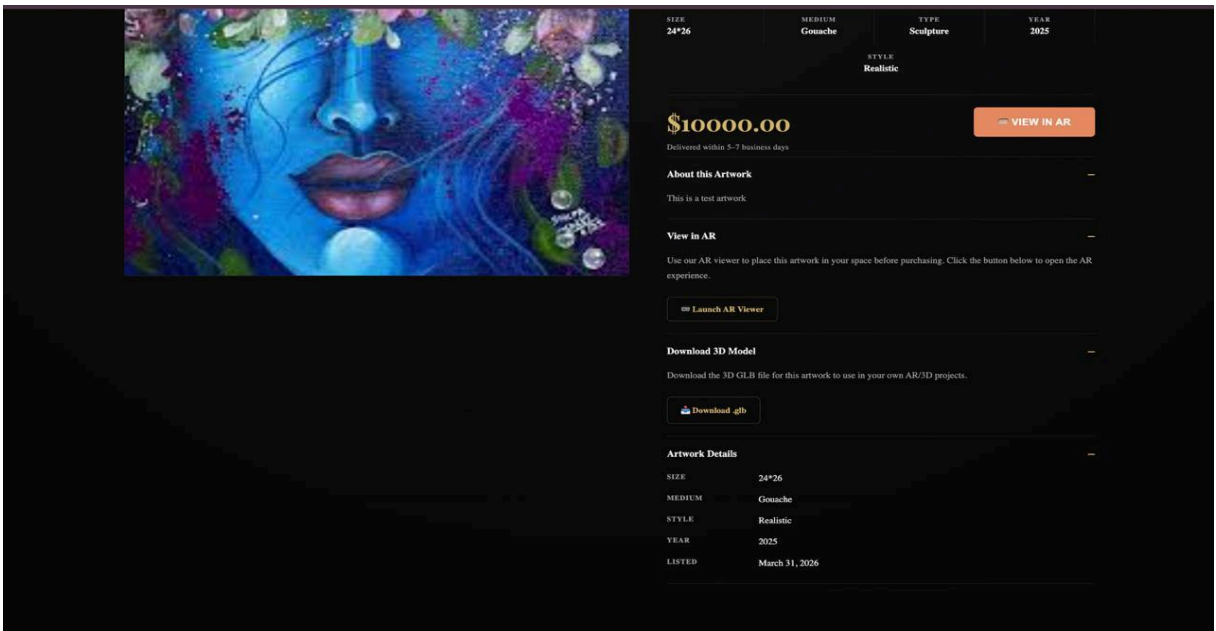


Figure 7.7 Artwork Details Page

Figures 7.6 and 7.7 show the marketplace and artwork detail view, where users can browse, filter, and select artworks, then view detailed information and download the 3D model, enhancing overall user interaction.

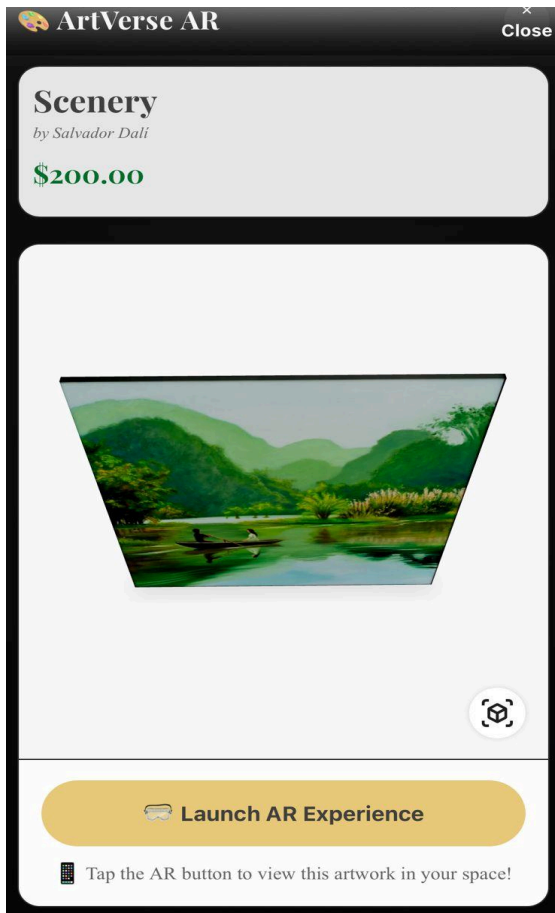


Fig 7.8 AR Preview Feature

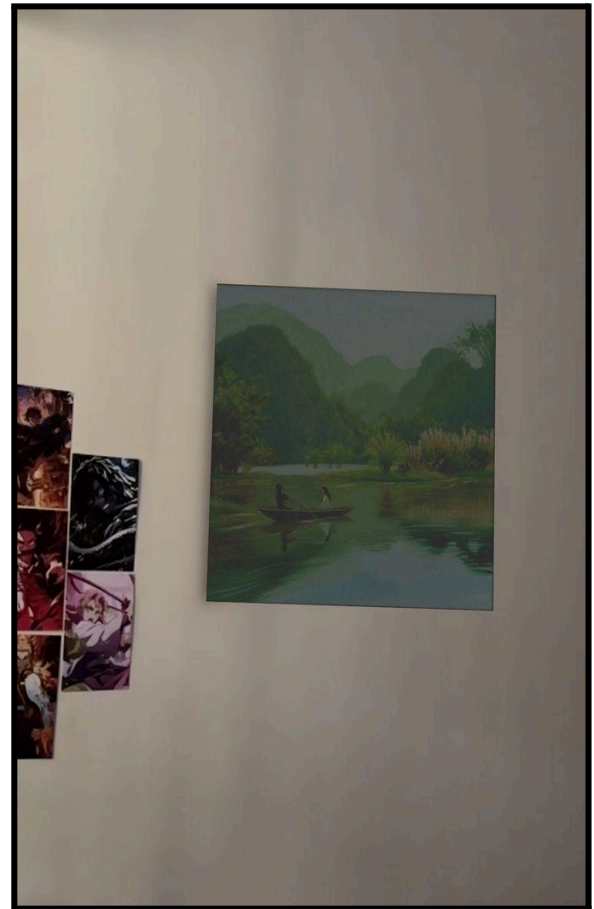


Fig 7.9 AR Preview on User Environment

Figure 7.8 shows the AR preview feature of the ArtVerse platform, where users can visualize an artwork in a realistic environment before purchasing. Figure 7.9 demonstrates the real-time AR visualization of the selected artwork placed on a wall in a user's environment. The feature allows accurate scaling and positioning, giving users a realistic preview of how the artwork will look in their space.

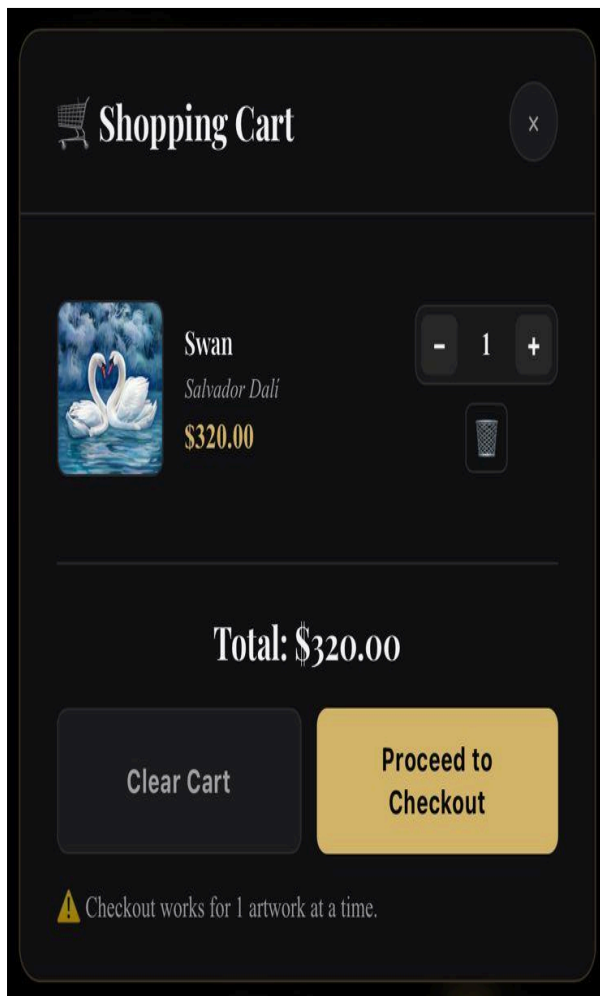
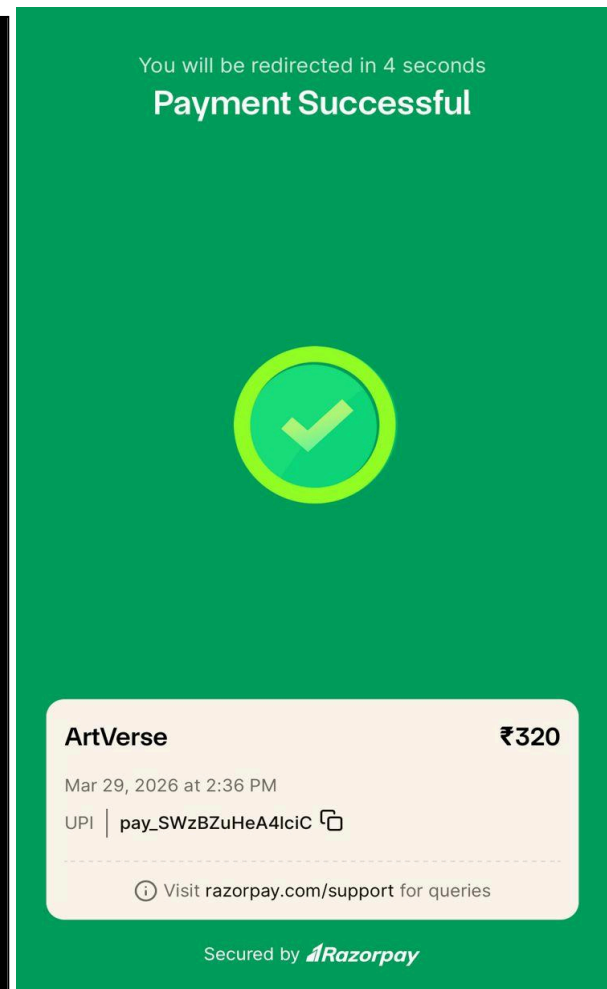
**Fig 7.10 Shopping Cart Interface****Fig 7.11 Transaction Confirmation Screen**

Figure 7.7 displays a shopping cart interface that allows users to view and manage selected artworks before proceeding to purchase. It displays item details such as artwork name, price, and quantity for easy review. Figure 7.8 shows the successful completion of a payment transaction within the platform. It confirms the payment status along with transaction details such as amount, date, and payment method.

CHAPTER 8

Project Plan

- **Gantt Chart**

A Gantt chart provides a comprehensive visual representation of the project timeline for the AR-enabled e-commerce platform for art collectors, illustrating how various tasks are planned and executed over a defined period. Each task is represented by a horizontal bar, where its position and length indicate the start and end dates as well as the duration of the activity. The chart clearly demonstrates the progression of the project through different phases such as requirement analysis, system design, development of core modules (including the seller dashboard, buyer interface, and AR integration), testing, and final deployment. It also highlights task dependencies, where certain activities begin only after the completion of preceding steps, while some processes run in parallel to optimize time and efficiency. A red vertical line is used to indicate the current progress within the timeline, allowing easy comparison between planned and actual progress.

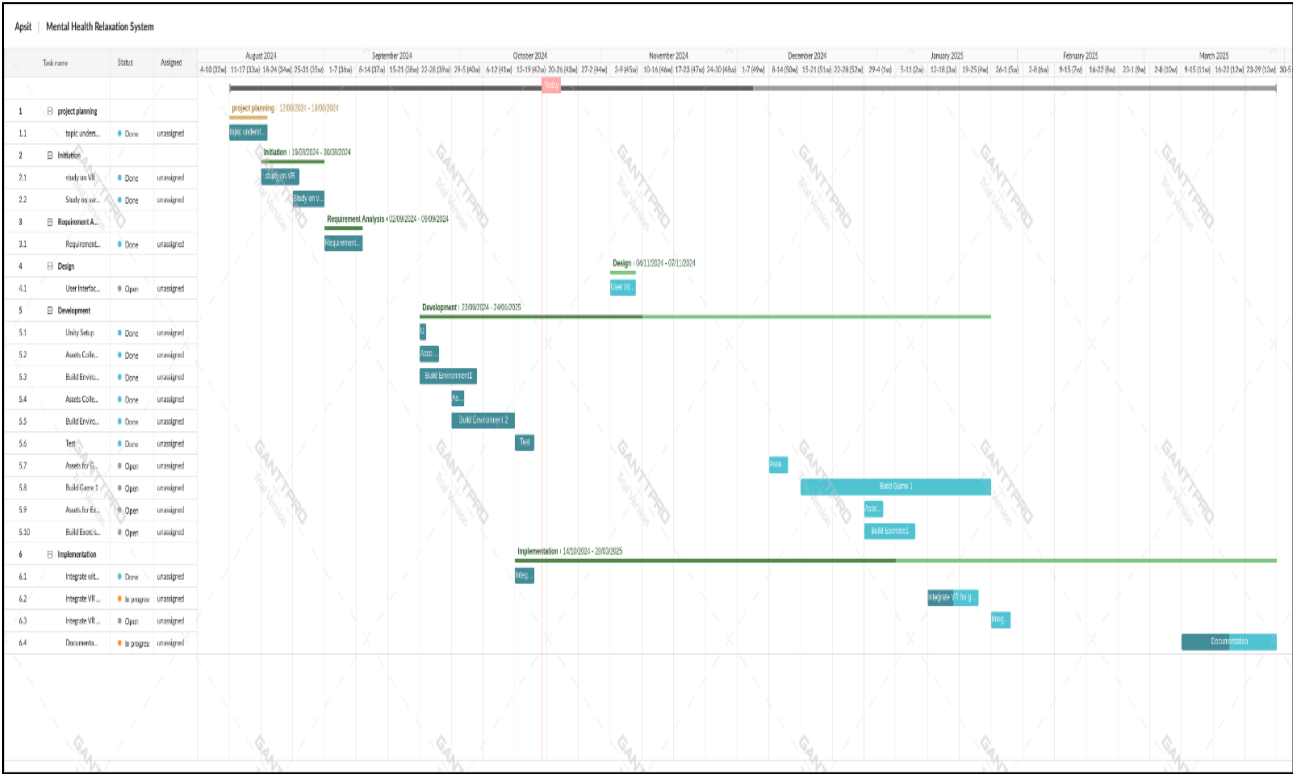


Figure 8.1 – Gantt Chart

It represents that the process began with the problem definition phase, where key challenges in traditional online art purchasing, such as lack of visualization and high return rates, were identified and project objectives were established. Then it was followed by project planning with technology selection and workflow design. The data preparation phase involved collecting artwork images and metadata, while the development phase focused on implementing AR visualization, image-to-3D conversion, and AI-based features. This was followed by application development, including buyer and seller modules, and finally, testing and refinement phase involved evaluating system performance, fixing issues, and optimizing usability to ensure a reliable and efficient platform before deployment.

CHAPTER 9

Conclusion

The AR-enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors provides an innovative solution to overcome issues like poor visualization, size inaccuracy, and high return rates in traditional online art buying. By integrating real-time AR, AI-based metadata, and a robust architecture, it enables realistic artwork previews in user spaces. The results show improved conversion rates, higher user satisfaction, and reduced product returns, proving the effectiveness of AR.

In addition to its technical achievements, the project achieves multiple Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through its design and functionality. It supports SDG 8 and SDG 10 by providing a direct digital marketplace where artists can showcase and sell their work globally, eliminating dependency on traditional galleries and ensuring equal opportunities regardless of location or background. Through AR technology and scalable architecture, it contributes to SDG 9 by fostering innovation. Additionally, AR previews reduce physical visits and returns, supporting sustainable consumption aligned with SDG 11. Overall, the project not only enhances the online art buying experience but also establishes a scalable and sustainable technological framework that can be extended to other retail domains such as furniture, fashion, and home décor, thereby redefining the future of immersive and responsible e-commerce.

CHAPTER 10

Future Scope

1. Integration of Advanced AI Personalization

The system can be improved by adding AI-based recommendations to suggest artworks based on user preferences and behavior.

2. Expansion to Full 3D and Interactive Art Models

Future development can include support for fully interactive 3D artworks and sculptures instead of only planar image-to-3D conversions, allowing users to rotate, zoom, and interact with artworks more realistically in AR environments.

3. Improved Performance and Real-Time Rendering

Optimizing AR performance by using faster rendering techniques, cloud-based processing, and reduced model loading time can address current limitations such as lower load speed and enhance overall user experience.

4. Extension to Other E-Commerce Domains

The developed AR framework can be scaled and adapted for other industries such as furniture, fashion, and home décor, enabling realistic product visualization across multiple retail sectors and broadening the application scope of the system.

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Annexure-I

Project Cost Estimation

Category of Software Project: Semi-Detached

Assumptions

- Effort Adjustment Factor (EAF) = 1
- Estimated Lines of Code (LOC) = 18,000
- KLOC = 18

Effort Estimation (COCOMO Model)

Formula (Semi-Detached):

$$E = a \times (\text{KLOC})^b \times \text{EAF}$$

Inputs:

$$a = 3.0, b = 1.12$$

Calculated Effort (E):

$$E = 3.0 \times (18)^{1.12} = 76.2 \text{ Person-Months}$$

Time Estimation

Formula:

$$T = c \times (E)^d$$

Inputs:

$$c = 2.5, d = 0.35$$

Calculated Time (T):

$$T = 2.5 \times (76.2)^{0.35} = 12.5 \text{ Months}$$

Team Size & Duration

- Team Size (P): 3 Members

- Theoretical Time:
 $T = \frac{E}{P} = \frac{76.2}{3} = 25 \text{ Months}$
- Practical Duration (Academic Scope): **6–7 Months**
(Scope reduced to core features)

Summary

- Effort (E): 76.2 Person-Months
- Time (COCOMO): 12.5 Months
- Practical Development Time: 6–7 Months
- Team Size: 3 Members

Cost Estimation

1. Developer Cost

- Avg Salary: ₹15,000/month
- Total Cost: $7 \times 15,000 \times 3 = ₹3,15,000$

2. System Cost: Existing infrastructure with minimal setup
 = ₹25,000

3. AR-Specific Cost: Device testing & rendering validation
 = ₹15,000

4. Software Cost: Open-source tools (Flask, React, model-viewer)
 = ₹0

Total Cost

$$₹3,15,000 + ₹25,000 + ₹15,000 = ₹3,55,000$$

Final Statement

Total Project Cost = ₹3,65,000/-

Publication

The research paper was submitted to the *Computer Graphics and Applications, IEEE*, *International Journal of Interactive Multimedia and Artificial Intelligence (IJIMAI)*, and *Multimedia Tools and Applications*, and is currently awaiting acceptance.

AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collectors

Dr. Rushikesh R. Nikam
rrnikam@apist.edu.in

Krushnali Biradar
biradarkrushnali@gmail.com

Gopika Barot
barotgopika@gmail.com

Palak Boricha
Palakboricha1208@gmail.com

Deepak Khachane
dskhachane@apsit.edu.in

Dr. Harshali Bhuwad
hsbhuwad@apsit.edu.in

Department of Computer Engineering
A.P. Shah Institute of Technology
Thane, India

Abstract- With the rise of digital commerce, the traditional art markets have gone through a significant transformations. But, the online platforms don't provide the immersive experience of a physical art gallery. This project suggests a virtual art gallery-based e-commerce platform which uses AR technology. To make buying and selling artworks process easier while improving user experiences. Through immersive visualization and standard e-commerce features like viewing and filtering artworks, secure authentication for buyers and sellers, and cart managements are included in this system. The use of Augmented Reality technology is the key benefit of this platform. This allows users to preview selected artworks using their mobile's camera before a purchase in their actual personal environment. This features gives users a better experience by letting them see artworks in the real world and tackling the spatial context issues faced in online art sales. The integration of AR turns off the gap between digital images and real-world placements which greatly increasing the buyer confidence. The platform is built using Flask-driven architecture and features a responsive web interface, which ensures efficient performances. According to the experimental results of the proposed system, it has made users decision-making processes more efficient. This leads to a measurable improvement compared to traditional e-commerce models in user engagement and conversion rates.

Index Terms: Augmented Reality (AR), WebAR, Online Art Marketplace, Immersive E-Commerce, Digital Art Platform, User Purchase Confidence, AR-Based Visualization.

INTRODUCTION

The evolving transformations in digital commerce has changed the global art industry. This has given rise to the online art marketplace. Making it an essential channel for buying and selling artwork. In the context of art exhibitions and galleries, e-commerce refers to the digital platforms which are used to exhibit and securely transact art over the internet. This rapid shift allows artists to reach an international audience. This also allows collectors to explore diverse art works without geographical limitations. But online art purchasing presents an important experiential limitation despite its advantages. Artwork is inherently physical and spatial. Its appreciation depends on scale, texture, depth, and contextual placement within a real environment where Traditional interfaces rely on static images, limited zoom capabilities, and textual descriptions, which we cannot accurately convey these physical attributes. This limitation prevents buyers from the visualisation of how an artwork will appear in their own space, making spatial judgment difficult. Because art purchasing decisions are highly emotional. The absence of realistic visualization increases cognitive effort, reduces user purchase

confidence, leads to hesitation during purchase decisions, and contributes to higher return rates. And hence constraining the effectiveness of digital art commerce.

Augmented Reality (AR) offers a compelling solution to this visualization gap. This overlays digital objects within the real-world environment in real time. In art retails, AR-based visualisation through in-situ visualization is supported by AR. This allows collectors to preview artwork on their space at accurate size and position. As WebAR continues to grow it increases accessibility by delivering experiences directly through web browsers without requiring app downloads. In contrast, many existing systems prevent a fully immersive e-commerce experience. As they remain limited to two-dimensional displays, inadequate interactive scaling, or application-dependent AR features. Integrating AR into digital art platforms is highly necessary to improve spatial understanding, strengthen emotional engagement, and increase buyer confidence, supporting the continued evolution of the online art marketplace.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Singh et al. resulted how Extended Reality (XR) is transforming the e-commerce system [1]. They focused on creating an engaging shopping experiences. They stated that these innovations are important for connecting the digital searching with real-world product markings. This supports the project's main idea that adding AR framework is important to increase the confidence of the buyer and decrease hesitation in online art purchases. A. J. Ifeanyi tested how AR is used in museum exhibitions and found that it increases audience attention and learning by describing the art pieces physically [2]. These idea influenced the project's goal of using AR concept to make the art viewing experience highly interactive and relatable. Similarly, L. Wang and H. Zhou executed a case study on Chinese artworks [3].

They found that AR successfully changes cultural pieces into an understandable digital displays. This transformed the way of platform's vision for an online art purchase that feels like an interactive museum.

M. Rees says AR as an "expansive object" that brings the emotional connect of art to life [4]. This showed the technical efforts to make sure that the presence of art truly reflects its emotions and scale. T. Aitamurto et al. provide data presenting that AR increases customers enjoyment while connecting with art [5]. This data helped to form the style to not be distracting and focused. Few e-commerce studies confirms the commercial workability of the system. N. T. Singh et al. highlight that to improve and enhance the confidence by connecting the digital browsing and real world product rating XR plays a very important role [6]. H. Chen studied customer psychology and found that XR creates trust and satisfaction, while reducing the risk [7]. This finding is important for buying high-value art online.

Kumar and R. Verma describe AR as a digital innovation that greatly improves product preview and interaction [8]. A. Gupta and R. Singh provide key data saying that AR not only increases purchases but also the customer's willingness to pays more for the arts, supporting the costing strategy of the platform [9]. J. Li and M. Zhang compared AR to classical web shopping and got that AR majorly improves both intention of the online purchasing and mainly user experience [10]. This became a main selling point for the project. The most important mark for the platform's financial structure come from A. Gupta and R. Singh, who provided proof that through AR customer willingly pays for the art pieces and not with AR intention [9]. This search explains the technical

investments in the AR services, as it directly effect the platform’s capability to maximized the revenue for a. J. Li and M. Zhang executed a direct comparison of AR and classical web shopping, determining that AR leads to a major improvement in both User Experience (UX) and Online Purchase Intention [10]. This research presents as the main point for making the AR preview the central feature and unique selling idea.

PROPOSED SYSTEM

The proposed system is a web-based AR Artwork Viewer & Gallery application built with Python Flask. This allows users to upload 2D artwork images then it converts them into 3D GLB models, and visualize them in augmented reality. User authentication, role-based access (buyers and sellers), and an auto-populated gallery with AI-generated metadata is supported by the platform. Essential components involve mobile-optimized uploads, real-time AR viewing via Google's model-viewer library, and bulk processing of artworks for gallery management..

- System Architecture

Google's model-viewer library is been used by the AR visualisation module to render the GLB models in web browsers that supports multiple AR modes (WebXR, Scene Viewer, Quick Look) with fixed scaling and to maintain real-world proportions (e.g., 60cm width). The features consists of a camera permission checks, network connectivity monitoring for mobile phone devices, and device-specific optimizations (e.g., file size limits of 5MB on mobile vs 10MB on desktop). Zooming and panning for consistent placements on walls, with debug informations for troubleshooting compatibility on iOS 12+ and Android 8.0+ devices will disable by AR activation

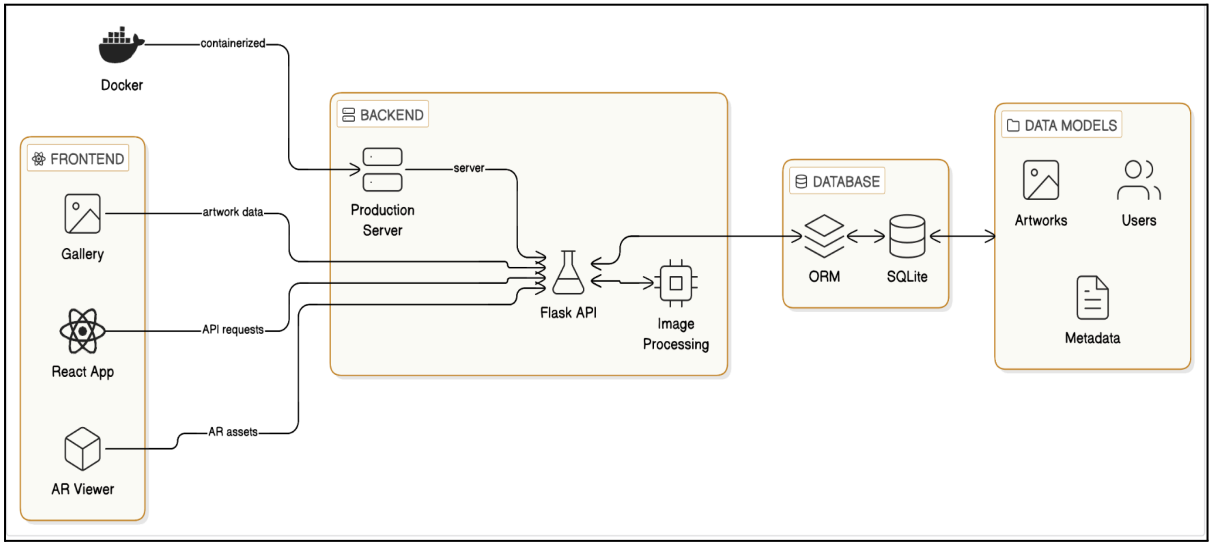


Figure 3.1 Architecture Diagram for AR enabled E-Commerce Platform for Art Collector

Google's model-viewer library is been used by the AR visualisation module to render the GLB models in web browsers that supports multiple AR modes (WebXR, Scene Viewer, Quick Look) with fixed scaling and to maintain real-world proportions (e.g., 60cm width). The features consists of a camera permission checks, network connectivity monitoring for mobile phone devices, and device-specific optimizations (e.g., file size limits of 5MB on mobile vs 10MB on desktop). Zooming and panning for consistent placements on walls, with debug informations for troubleshooting compatibility on iOS 12+ and Android 8.0+ devices will disable by AR activation.

Image-to-GLB conversions uses Pillow for image enhancement (e.g., contrast adjustment) and trimesh for 3D mesh generation. The algorithm creates a planar mesh from the image, extruding it to a specified thickness (default 0.01m), and exports as GLB. Caching using lru_cache which optimizes repeated conversions by hashing image data. Gallery auto-population uses AI for metadata generation, analyzing image characteristics to assign realistic prices, artists, and descriptions.

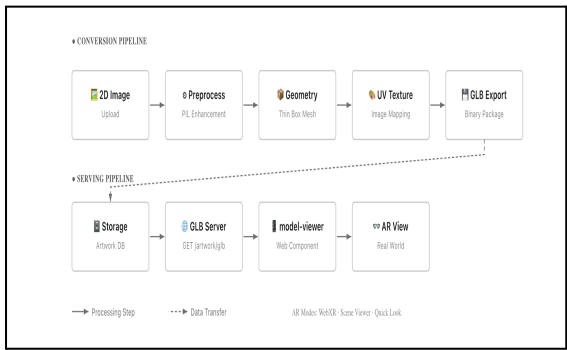


Figure 3.2 Conversion Flow of 2D Image to GLB format

IMPLEMENTATION

By combining augmented reality, media processing, optimized storage, and 3D asset generation, this system creates a single coherent application that serves all the needs related to building a fully complete web-based experience. The backend system uses Flask and it is organized as a single application module managing both routing, database interactions, file processing, and static assets all at once in one place. The frontend of the application is UI-based using React which communicates via the backend to display dynamic galleries; manages uploads; and, displays interactive 3D models. The design arranges performances based upon working across multiple devices while efficiently managing large amounts of media stored on disk.

Persisting data to disk is done using a relational, file-based SQLite database with different storage methods. At the centre of the database is an optimally structured schema using files to reference their paths and metadata; rather than storing binary media in the database's fields. This schema results in a reduced load on the database and increased speed of queries. Another legacy model exists in order to allow backward compatibility; it contains raw data in the database fields. A specific user model manages user authentication by associating identity and session data. Overall, this application allows for both scalable storage and continued support for systems that may have originally been built prior to implementing this mixed storage strategy.

The system includes a dedicated upload endpoint that will accept an image file for conversion into the three-dimension (3D) models in the system as well as to be processed as images. The uploaded file, when received by the upload handler, will verify the uploaded file and extract the metadata from the image, identify whether there are mobile client headers attached to the uploaded file, record diagnostic/logging information, and save the results to the database.

The image to three-dimensional (3D) conversion pipeline is a critical functionality of the platform. The uploaded images are then processed using an automated process that will normalize, scale, and enhance each uploaded image before creating the geometry describing the three-dimensional model. The aspect ratio for the uploaded images is analyzed to ensure the correct aspect ratio geometry when the mesh is generated. The generated mesh will create a box geometry that creates a box the same size as the originally 3D representation of the uploaded images; this is accomplished using a three-dimensional mesh processing package to create the necessary box geometry and then calculate UV coordinates for each of the created meshes so that the represented texture maps directly to the surface of the mesh in the created model. The output model is then exported in a GLB file format to reduce the file size of the exported model for faster transmission of data. Additionally, the support structures created include caching and memoized environments that allow for the reuse of previously processed images without needing to go through the conversion process again.

Optimized performance specialized routes are utilized to serve static media; these routes allow for efficient serving of thumbnails, full resolution images, and GLB assets by providing the correct content-type header, streaming response and long cache duration when serving files from the endpoint.

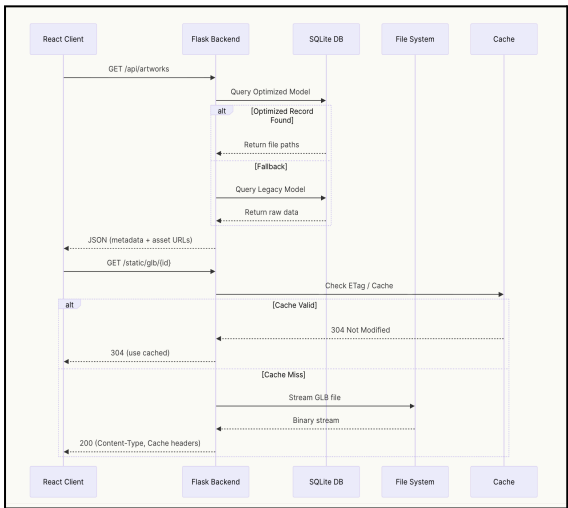


Figure 4.1 System Workflow

Workflows have been structured within the listing API to retrieve artworks entries using a hierarchical query model; the workflow attempts an optimized read from an optimized storage model before executing backup queries or legacy records as needed. Each API response includes structured metadata along with URLs to the thumbnail, full image and 3D asset, allowing the React frontend to leverage them for rapidly rendering. Individual artwork endpoints are present for retrieving separate image data, GLB models, or metadata. Responses for GLB models contain entity tags to facilitate browser-level caching and validation, thereby reducing any superfluous downloading of assets that have not changed since the last download.

APIs are used on the React components in the frontend to manage rendering logic, API interaction, and state management. The viewing interface includes a web-based 3D model viewer supporting AR mode evaluation and AR visualization in multiple ways (Android, iOS, and browser-based). The models are displayed at real-world scale in order to accurately represent the model in relation to the user's physical environment.

To increase the reliability of AR-enabled mobile devices despite varying network and device conditions, the AR implementation relies on comprehensive features implemented on the client side. This involves file size restrictions, detection of connectivity, processing of camera permissions, and automatic retries with an exponential backoff approach (meaning that each retry will occur faster than the previous retry if the connection has failed). Additionally, custom diagnostic headers are sent from the mobile AR clients to facilitate server-side debugging and performance analysis.

To assist in the secure AR visualization delivery with respect to cross-origin aspects via global CORS configuration combined with response middleware that adjusts headers, all responses are processed in such a way as to prevent conflicts with browser rendering policies or the mobile AR architecture.

Performance optimization is a key design factor at all levels of the system architecture. File-based storage

will be used for the storage of large assets thereby preventing database overheads. The caching for static media objects will be aggressively managed, and responses for GLB files will be returned with validation tokens to allow efficient reuse. Image processing will be limited to medium resolution and lightweight enhancement settings so that resource-limited servers can perform as quickly as possible. The architecture will also support background ingestion for large datasets for batch artwork population, and a caching layer is being considered to store the result of artwork conversion.

RESULTS

5.1 Reduction in returns with AR production

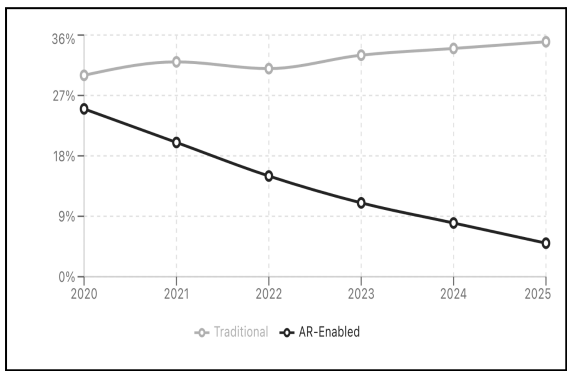


Figure 5.1 Product Return Rate Trend (%)

Figure shows the reduction in product return rates with the implementation of AR-enabled visualization. While the traditional e-commerce platform saw an increase in return rates from around 29% in 2020 to close to 36% in 2025, the AR-enabled platform saw a substantial decrease from 26% to close to 5% in the same period. This can be attributed to the improved visualization offered by AR, which enables customers to view artworks in their actual environment before making a purchase. This reduces the uncertainty of purchase and the likelihood of returns due to dissatisfaction with the product. Hence, the implementation of AR not only enhances customer confidence but also eliminates the associated costs of product returns.

5.2 User ratings of AR Gallery capabilities

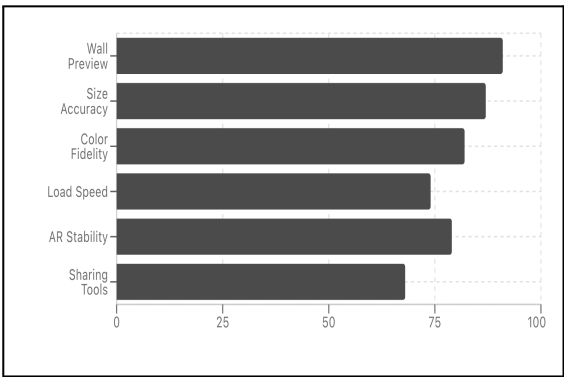


Figure 5.2 Gallery Feature Satisfaction (Score/100)

The above figures shows the user satisfaction rating for the most important feature of this AR-based gallery system. The highest rated feature was the wall preview feature which scored 92/100. This showed us the high appreciation ability of system to preview artworks in real world environment setting. Accuracy of size 88 and color accuracy 83 also scored high. This shows the accuracy of scaling and color representation have impact on user trust and their purchase decision. But load speed (74) and sharing functionality (68) scored relatively lower, showing areas for improvement in performance and social sharing functionality. Overall, the findings show that immersive visualisations capabilities are important for improving user engagement and decision-making in AR-based art e-commerce systems.

5.3 Conversion Rate Comparison

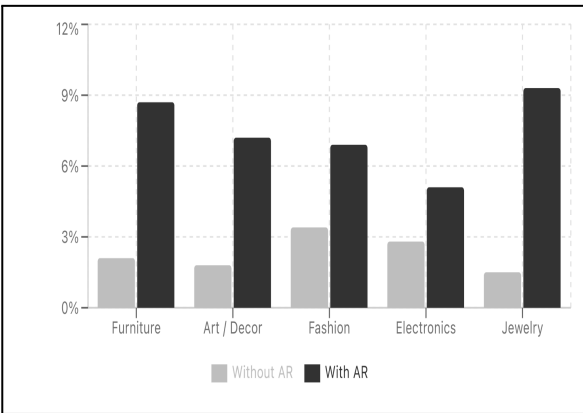


Figure 5.3 Conversion Rates of AR enabled vs Traditional Products

Figure illustrates the conversion rates between the traditional product page and AR-enabled product visualization for different categories of retail. The data shows, when AR functionality is provided, a significant improvement in the users' purchase completion rate. For example, the conversion rate for furniture items improved from 2.2% to 8.8%, and for art and decor items, it improved from 1.8% to 7.2%. The jewelry items recorded the significant increase, with the conversion rate improving from 1.5% to over 9%, which is a testament to the success of AR-based try-on functionality.

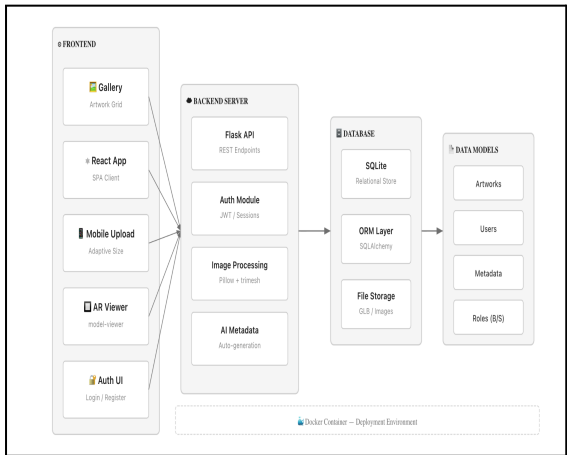


Figure 5.4 Client-server Architecture with AR Module Integration

The proposed AR-supported e-commerce system is based on a three-tier client-server architecture, this includes a frontend layer, backend application server, and database/storage tier. The frontend layer is built as a React-based single-page application (SPA) with gallery browsing, artwork upload, authentication views, and AR visualization using a model.

The backend application server is built using a Flask REST API, that includes authentication services (JWT/session-based), image processing libraries (Pillow and trimesh), and AI-driven metadata generation. The back end server has the responsibility of handling business logic, URL routing, and communication between the client and data layers. Using SQLite for relational data storage the layer data is built, which is handled using the SQLAlchemy

ORM. The artwork files (GLB models and images) are stored in a separate file storage system. Docker is used to containerise the application for scalability and consistency in deployment.

CONCLUSION

The study has shown the design and development of an Augmented Reality (AR) aided e-commerce solutions specially designed for art collectors. The main goal of this idea was to handle and resolve the main drawbacks of the classic online art buying processes, including ambiguity of visualization, ability of size calculation faults, aesthetic discrepancy, and most relative high returns.

The proposed system of project blends a three-tier client-server architecture with the real-time AR visualization, AI-powered metadata creation, and also authentication processes. The system provides art purchasers to visualize the artworks in their own real-world environment, thus it enhances their spaces and purchase decisions. The system development explain the smooth integration of AR functionality with a present e-commerce system without impacting its usability and performances. The experimental results shows considerable improvements in the major output metrics. The transformation rates higher in AR-blended products pages than of the conventional ones. The user satisfaction reviews were highest for the wall preview feature and size accuracy features, thus resolving the need for realistic visualization in art buying decisions. Further, the return rate analysis shows the major reduction with the acceptance of AR technology, thus revealing the working and sustainable advantages of AR technology for e-commerce systems.

In conclusion, the study confirms that effectful AR visualization results in decreased risks, increased engagement, and improved performance for the buyer. In addition to improve the user experience, the platform also result in decreasing logistical costs and provides optimized e-commerce practices. In conclusion, the blending of the AR features is a revolutionary step taken in the digital era of art

e-commerce field. The developed system not only improves the buying experience for art consumers but also reveals a technological framework which can be easily extended to other retail fields such as furniture, fashion, and home decor for visualization.

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